# THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

## Paris Branch Newsletter - January 2014

**FOR YOUR DIARY:**

26th February: Club Lunch*
27th March: Club Lunch*
23rd April: St George's Day Club Lunch*
16th-18th May: Battlefield Visit to Dunkirk.
*All details on last page below

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### Chairman's Report

- Even at this late stage of the month of January the local custom allows me to wish you and yours a very Happy New Year in 2014. Nevertheless those last two figures 14 still send a shiver down our spines, as one hundred years after the outbreak of the First World War we plan to commemorate that landmark event appropriately. Your Committee is already alert, listening out for the plans still to be announced in detail by the French Government on how the Centenary will be commemorated nationally, and whether the RBL will have any part to play in any of those events. Our own traditional ceremony on the 4th August when Britain and the Commonwealth rekindle the Flame at the Arc de Triomphe will itself have a special poignancy. In addition the British and Commonwealth Governments are planning a series of Centenary events over the next 4 years in the battlefields of France and Belgium, and we shall keep our members informed as those dates are announced. In this context your Committee is particularly concerned to participate where possible in events for the young in the British Community. To that end we are just beginning a dialogue with the English-speaking schools in the Ile-de-France to establish how we can contribute to their pupils' understanding of the significance of those horrific events of 100 years ago. In February/March we expect to see the publication of a book master-minded by Grahame Warby which will recount the personal stories of Paris Branch members who experienced the Second World War first-hand, plus some peacetime memories of members in the King's or Queen's uniform. Details of the price and the purchasing of this book will be announced to you shortly. The net proceeds will be credited to the Paris Branch General Fund. I take this opportunity to thank Grahame for his brilliant initiative and by purchasing his book you can express your thanks too.
- On the home front we should like to welcome the arrival of Fiona Terris to the Paris Branch Committee. As a previous P.A. to the British Defence Attaché her experience will prove invaluable to us.
- In our Clubhouse we have accumulated in a haphazard way a number of books on military subjects and your Committee with Vicky Millet's assistance would like to formalize our embryonic library in such a way that in future members will be able to borrow these books. If you are sitting on any suitable books at home why not consider donating them to our young collection ?
- Finally you will find below the details of Commonwealth War Grave Cemeteries in the Paris area. As Spring approaches and you begin to think of outings it might give you the inspiration to take your children or grandchildren to pay their respects. We can supply you with the RBL Poppy crosses.

**"We will remember them"**

# Commonwealth War Graves in the Paris Area

The information in this note has been provided by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission, following a request from the Paris Branch. We had enquired how many Commonwealth war graves were in the Paris area, and their location. The data on the cemeteries concerned can be summarized as follows:

| Commune | Département | 1914-18 Casualties* | 1939-45 Casualties |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bagneux | 92 | Over 30 | A small number |
| Bièvres | 91 | - | Over 10 |
| Clichy Northern | 92 | - | Over 200 |
| Les Gonards, Versailles | 78 | Over 150* | 10 |
| Levallois-Perret | 92 | Nearly 30* | - |
| Neuilly-sur-Seine Old | 92 | 1 | - |
| Pantin | 93 | Nearly 100 | - |
| Pontoise | 95 | A small number | Over 10 |
| St Germain-en-Laye New | 78 | A small number | Nearly 10 |
| Villeneuve-St Georges – Old | 94 | Over 10* | Nearly 50 |
| - New | 94 | - | Over 20 |
| Viroflay | 78 | - | Over 70 |
| | | **TOTAL: 330** | **Approx. 400** |

*= Commentary by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission as follows:

1. **First World War** casualties fall into three categories:

   i) The earliest are the soldiers who died of wounds in French and British hospitals in or near Paris in 1914, when the ambulance trains ran south-westward from the Aisne and the Marne;

   ii) The soldiers present in the Aisne and the Marne in the summer of 1918;

   iii) Men who died after the Armistice.

2. **Les Gonards, Versailles:** The great majority of casualties died in N° 4 General Hospital in 1914-15.

3. **Levallois-Perret:** The cemetery was used by the Hertford British Hospital. 4 of these graves were brought from the permanent American Cemetery at Suresnes.

4. **Villeneuve-St Georges Old**: The majority died in 1914, when the railway station was on the British lines of communication and a British ambulance station was posted there.

**THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION**
**PARIS BRANCH**

**TOMBOLA RESULTS**

| Name | Ticket Number | Prize | Taken/Not Taken |
|---|---|---|---|
| **DAGBERT** | **2965** | **2 x Champagne** | **Returned for future Tombola** |
| **COCKLE** | **1719** | **Bale of Towels** | **Taken by J. Warby** |
| **AUDUC** | **1037** | **Porcelaine Cup** | **Taken by J. Warby** |
| **HALLOCHE** | **2663** | **2 x Champagne** | **Taken by D. Neil** |
| **PERON** | **2524** | **2 x Soaps** | **Taken** |
| **THOUROT** | **718** | **Cheese Board** | **Taken by J. Hicks** |
| **CAMOUS ( Kinloch)** | **1484** | **1 x Champagne** | **Not taken** |
| **WALKER** | **1178** | **Bus Trip** | **Taken** |
| **WARBY Diane** | **624** | **Chocolates** | **Taken by J. Warby** |
| **THORN** | **025** | **Poppy Brooch** | **Taken** |
| **CRETEL** | **2942** | **Foie Gras Basket** | **Taken** |
| **LONGLEY** | **1320** | **6 x Wine & glasses** | **Taken by R. Thorn** |
| **COCKLE** | **1704** | **Boat Trip DFDS** | **Taken by J Warby** |
| **CLARKE GERVOISE (Diana Neil)** | **2672** | **Whisky** | **Taken by F. Terris** |
| **SPENCER-BERNARD** | **3404** | **Disney Toy** | **Taken** |
| **WARBY, Alex** | **640** | **Clock** | **Taken by J. Warby** |
| **HALLOWS** | **3230** | **Steak Knives** | **Taken** |
| **SCOTT** | **919** | **Gift Bag** | **Taken** |
| **PERIDI** | **2550** | **Gift Bag** | **Not taken** |
| **STAM** | **3382** | **Gift Bag** | **Taken by J. Warby** |
| **MAMBRET** | **2431** | **Jacket & Bag** | **Taken** |
| **CORRIGAN** | **1639** | **Gift Bag** | **Not taken** |

**We would like to thank all those who took part in our Christmas Draw. Could all those who have not received their prize please contact Miss Joan Hicks – 01 30 54 33 06 to arrange for collection. Prizes not taken by end of March will be put into later draws.**

## CLUB LUNCHES

| | |
|---|---|
| **February**<br>**Wednesday 26th** | Club Lunch. 12.15 for 12.45 Price €16 per person to include appero, 3 course lunch, tea/coffee. Wine to be bought at the bar. |
| **March**<br>**Thursday 27th** | Club Lunch. 12.15 for 12.45 Price €16 per person to include appero, 3 course lunch, tea/coffee. Wine to be bought at the bar. |
| **April**<br>**Wednesday 23rd** | St. George's Day lunch. Price €16 per person to include appero, 3 course lunch, tea/coffee. Wine to be bought at the bar. 12.15 for 12.45 |
| **May**<br>**Thursday 22nd** | Club lunch. 12.15 for 12.45 Price €16 per person to include appero, 3 course lunch, tea/coffee. Wine to be bought at the bar. |
| **June**<br>**Thursday 26th** | Club lunch. 12.15 for 12.45 Price €16 per person to include appero, 3 course lunch, tea/coffee. Wine to be bought at the bar. |

Please contact Miss Joan Hicks, 6 rue des Petits Prés, 78810 Feucherolles or 01 30 54 33 06/06 19 17 34 48. Or fill out the reply slip below and send together with your cheque(s) made payable to : **"The Royal British Legion"**, for the full amount. Should you be unable to attend please let Miss Hicks know at least two working days before the event for a refund. Failure to do so will mean forfeiture of amount you have paid. We ask that you give one cheque per lunch. This helps the Events Secretary with the accounting each month.

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### Reply Slip for Lunches

I _____ would like to attend the lunch on

February 26th* _____ March 27th* _____ April 23rd* _____ May 22nd* _____ June 26th* _____

I enclose my cheque(s) payable to "The Royal British Legion" for €_____**

I will/will not be bringing a guest *

Signed_____ Date _____

*Please indicate which lunch you would like to attend and if you are bringing a guest.

**Please give one cheque for each lunch. This helps with accounting for the Events Secretary.